Dan Barber, the top chef with a Blue Hill restaurant in Manhattan and another on a farm outside New York, teaches all his staff the principles of good farming.

smoked tomato soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

10 large plum tomatoes, about 2½lb (1.1kg) total in weight, 2 halved and seeded, 8 coarsely chopped
4 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
1 large onion, finely chopped
1 large leek, cut in half lengthwise and then thinly sliced crosswise
1½ tsp coriander seeds
2 garlic cloves, crushed
2 bay leaves
1 tsp finely grated fresh horseradish or drained bottled horseradish
1 cup hot chicken stock
pinch of sugar
4 tbsp unsalted butter, softened
salt and freshly ground black pepper
basil leaves, to garnish

1 Scatter a handful of apple, pecan, or hickory wood barbecue chips in a medium-sized, cast-iron frying pan or wok, cover tightly with a lid, and place over medium heat. When the chips start to smoke, put the 4 tomato halves on a rack, and set the rack in the pan. Replace the lid and smoke the tomatoes for 2–3 minutes or until barely softened. Transfer to a plate and let cool slightly, then peel.

2 Heat the oil in a large pan, add the onion and leek, and cook over medium heat, stirring frequently, for 10 minutes or until softened but not browned. Add the coriander, garlic, bay leaves, and horseradish and cook for 2 minutes or until fragrant. Add the chopped tomatoes, stock, and sugar, cover with a lid, and cook over medium heat for 10 minutes or until the tomatoes are soft. Pick out and discard the bay leaves.

3 Transfer to a blender, add the butter and smoked tomatoes, and process until smooth. You may need to do this in batches. Strain through a sieve into a clean pot and season with salt and freshly ground black pepper. Serve garnished with basil leaves.